

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD  
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

ORDER NO. 73-189

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS  
FOR  
UNITED STATES FOREST SERVICE  
INYO NATIONAL FOREST  
DEVIL'S POSTPILE FACILITIES  
Madera County

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, finds:

1. The United State Forest Service filed a Report of Waste Discharge dated 1 November 1972, for disposal of 0.033 MGD of domestic wastes originating in Pumice Flat Campground, Minaret Flat Campground, Red's Meadow Campground and Ranger Station, Sotcher Lake Recreation Area, and Devil's Postpile Monument Headquarters.
2. The waste treatment facilities will consist of a package treatment plant and leach field system located in the southwest quarter of Section 11 (extended), T4S, R26E, MDB&M, and over 1/4 mile from Middle Fork San Joaquin River.
3. The beneficial uses of the San Joaquin River are:
  - a. aesthetics
  - b. recreation including fishing
  - c. domestic supply
  - d. irrigation
  - e. preservation and enhancement of fish and wildlife
  - f. hydroelectric power generation
4. The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, adopted an Interim Water Quality Control Plant for the San Joaquin River Subbasin on 15 June 1971.
5. The Board has notified the discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for the proposed discharge.
6. The Board in a public meeting has heard and considered comments pertaining to the discharge.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED, United States Forest Service, Inyo National Forest shall comply with the following:

A. Waste Discharge Specifications

1. The discharge shall not cause a pollution of surface or ground water.

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2. Neither the treatment nor the discharge shall cause a nuisance.
3. The waste discharge shall not directly enter surface water or surface water drainage courses.
4. There shall be no overflow or bypass of untreated or partially treated wastes.
5. The waste discharge shall remain underground at all times.
6. The discharge shall not cause concentrations of any materials in the receiving waters which are deleterious to human, plant, animal or aquatic life.

B. Prohibitions

1. The discharge of wastes to subsurface leaching systems is prohibited in locations where any one of the following conditions exist:
  - a. Soil depths below the invert of the leaching trench is less than five feet.
  - b. Depth to ground water below the invert of the leaching trench is less than five feet.
  - c. Ground slopes in the disposal area are greater than 30%.
  - d. Standard percolation tests in the disposal area show values greater than 60 minutes per inch.
  - e. Leach lines or seepage pits are located less than 100 feet from the channel of any natural water course as measured at the 100-year flood line.
  - f. Within 100 feet of any public or private water well.

C. Provisions

1. Discharge of wastes shall not commence until the discharger submits information to substantiate that measures necessary to meet waste discharge requirements have been taken.
2. A copy of the requirements shall be maintained at the treatment facility and be available at all times to plant operating personnel.
3. The discharger shall comply with the Monitoring and Reporting Program No. \_\_\_\_\_ as specified by the Executive Officer.

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4. The discharger shall report promptly to the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, any material change or proposed change in the character, location, or volume of the discharge.
5. The Board will review this order periodically and may revise the requirements when necessary.

I, JAMES A. ROBERTSON, Executive Officer, do hereby certify the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, on 27 April 1973.

Original signed by  
James A. Robertson

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Executive Officer

RGW/cb revised 04/11/73

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The Forest Service proposes to abandon their present pit toilets at these local campgrounds and install a package type treatment plant. Effluent will be disposed to subsurface leaching fields. The design capacity of the collection and treatment facilities and disposal field will be 0.0326 MGD. The collection, treatment, and disposal facilities are to serve during the recreational season, Memorial Day to October.

There is no ground water hydrology available for the area. The area is at an elevation of 7,600 feet. The normal annual precipitation at Red's Meadow is 48 inches and annual evaporation is about 35 inches.

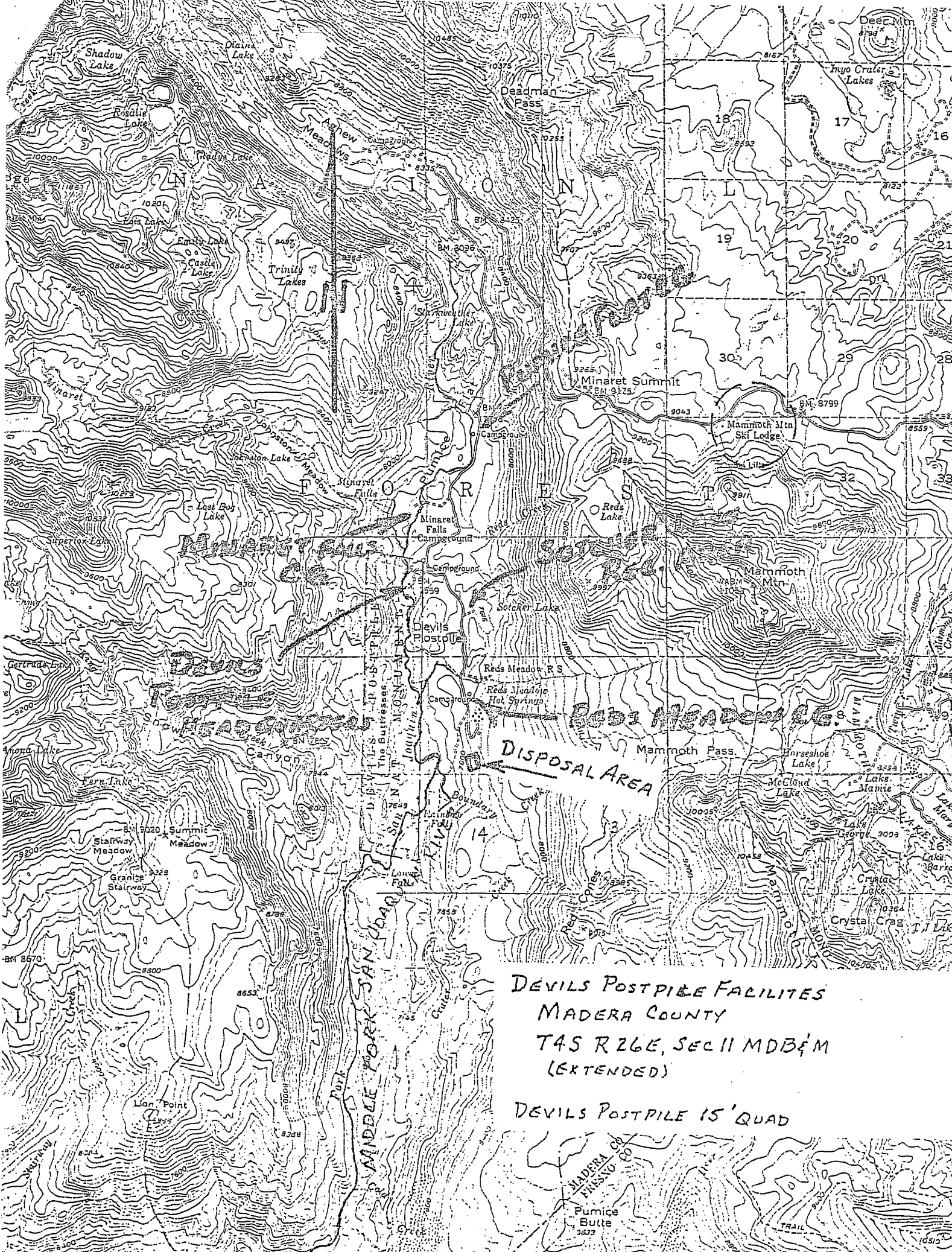
The Middle Fork San Joaquin River is more than a thousand feet to the west. Access to the river from this area and downstream is difficult. The primary uses of the stream in this area is as habitat for aquatic life, esthetic enjoyment, and fishing. The John Muir Trail parallels the river through the monument area.

The waters of the San Joaquin River are of excellent quality. Historical analyses of samples collected from the river at Kerchoff Reservoir indicate specific conductances to be approximately 30 to 40 micromhos.

The geology of the area consists of Pleistocene volcanic and pyroclastic rocks. The soils are considered to be moderately permeable. Percolation tests indicate rapid percolation at rates of 1.3 and 3.6 minutes per inch.

Waste discharge requirements have been prepared which require that the effluent remain underground at all times. Also, direct discharge to surface water drainage courses has been prohibited.

04/11/73 RGW/cb



DEVILS POSTPILE FACILITIES  
MADERA COUNTY  
T4S R26E, SEC II MDB&M  
(EXTENDED)

DEVILS POSTPILE 15' QUAD

Pumice Butte  
3523